

All about skin

Skin covers your whole body. It protects you from germs, water, and sunshine, and helps keep your body at the right temperature.

The skin on your eyelids is the thinnest on your body.

Two layers

Your skin has two main layers. The top one – the one you can see – is called the epidermis.

Underneath is the dermis, where there are nerves and blood vessels.



There are flat cells on the surface of your skin. These are made from a tough material called keratin. When the cells die, they dry out and flake off.

Skin cells lower down replace the dead ones that flake off.



Waterproof seal

Skin stops water getting into your body when you have a shower or go for a swim. It also stops fluids escaping from inside you.



Magnified skin flakes

House dust

Dust is mostly made of dead skin. Dust mites feed on this skin. They live in beds, pillows, and carpets.



Dust mites aren't really this big! They're so small you can't see them.

The thickest skin on

Skin is a sort of stretchy overcoat.

Heavy load

Skin is the heaviest single part of your body. It can weigh as much as a bag of shopping.